

## UNDERSTANDING\_KEY.md — the access ladder (an AUDITOR, and it says so)

The harness in this repo guards translation fidelity — an adversarial, non-enumerable claim space. **This file is the other thing:** the understanding-as-key access ladder, which is an *enumerable checklist plus a human door*, i.e. an **auditor** (ADOPTION Step 0 upstream: what you can count, count; running the Gap on an enumerable list is the universe-builder's catalogued mistake). Naming that honestly is part of the design.

### The rungs, as checkable facts

Per participant, per rung — every item is a yes/no a script or a stranger can check:

| rung        | checklist                                                                                             |
|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Traveler    | consent row signed (CONSENT_LEDGER.md) · ≥1 expression admitted to corpus/                            |
| Contributor | ≥1 (claim, form) pair of theirs carried through a VALIDATED round (verdict.json replayable)           |
| Author      | a full triptych of theirs VALIDATED (all three forms declared + census passed)                        |
| Mentor      | served as blind assayer on ≥1 round (named in that round's chronicle; never saw the canon that round) |
| Fellow      | ≥1 register claim of theirs folded by the keystone (visible in canon/UNDERSTANDING.md history)        |

## The cookie jar (graduated access to the mage)

Access deepens with the rung — host-scoped, brokered, never a raw credential in anyone's context (C8):

| rung        | jar                                            |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Traveler    | converse with the mage (read + chat)           |
| Contributor | submit triptychs to the round runner           |
| Author      | propose corpus folds to the steward            |
| Mentor      | hold the assay seat                            |
| Fellow      | sit with the keystone when the register amends |

*The steward's weekly key is separate from the ladder — every student holds it exactly once (CURRICULUM.md).*

## The door

The last check on every rung is human: the facilitator (and on outward acts, the First Person) confirms the checklist and turns the key. An auditor plus a door — never a self-certifying gate, which would be the exact trust the proverb warns about (C30).